

Mutating Virus

A mutating virus changes, or mutates, as it progresses through its host files making disinfection more difficult. The term usually refers to viruses that intentionally mutate, though some experts also include non-intentionally mutating viruses. See also: Polymorphic Virus

Network Creeper

Viruses that spread to new hosts by finding writable network drives (or 'shares') and copying themselves there or infecting files on those shares are sometimes referred to as network creepers.

Notifier

Any tool designed for stealth notification of an attacker that a victim has installed and run some pest. Such notification might be done by FTP, SMS, SMTP, or other method, and might contain a variety of information. Often used in combination with a Packer, a Binder and a Downloader.

Newsgroup

An electronic forum where readers post articles and follow-up messages on a specified topic. An Internet newsgroup allows people from around the globe discuss common interests. Each newsgroup name indicates the newsgroup's subject in terms of increasingly narrow categories, such as alt.comp.virus.

Oligomorphic Virus

An encrypted virus that has several forms of its decryption code, selecting between them (usually randomly) when writing its decryptor for a new replicant.

Overwriter

In general, the simplest form of virus is a program that just copies itself over the top of other programs. Such viruses are known as overwriters and are commonly the first types of viruses written for newly 'virused' platforms (e.g. Phage, the first PalmOS virus, discovered in late 2000, was a simple overwriter).